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[Memodiksyon Kreyòl Ayisyen KLIKE ISIT](#)

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The Second Regular Meeting of the Medford School Committee

January 29, 2024

Regular Meeting: 6:00 PM

Please be advised that there will be a Meeting of the Medford School Committee held at the Howard Alden Memorial Chambers, Medford City Hall and via remote participation.

The meeting can be viewed through Medford Community Media on Comcast and Verizon. Participants can participate in person or remotely by using the following information:

Medford Public Schools invites you to a meeting with a remote participation option.		
Virtual Link	https://mps02155-org.zoom.us/j/93689268022	
Meeting ID	936 8926 8022	
Dial by Location	https://mps02155-org.zoom.us/j/93689268022	

Agenda

- I. Roll Call for Attendance of Members and Student Representatives
- II. Salute the Flag
- III. Consent Agenda
 - Bills and Payrolls
 - Regular School Committee Minutes, **January 8, 2024**
 - Student Advisory Council Minutes, **November 15, 2023**
- IV. Report of Subcommittees
- V. Report of the Superintendent
 1. **Superintendent's Updates and Comments** - Dr. Marice Edouard-Vincent, Superintendent
 2. **Recommendation to Approve** travel to Dartmouth College, Hanover, New Hampshire with Model United Nations - Matthew Brophy, MHS History teacher and Dr. Nicole Chiesa, Director of Humanities

3. **Math Placement Presentation** - presented by Faiza Khan, Director of Mathematics
4. **School Update** - Curtis Tufts High School, presented by Laurie Hodgdon, Principal and Brooks Elementary School, presented by Shannon Demos, Principal
5. **Excessive Heat Protocol**- Dr. Peter J. Cushing, Assistant Superintendent of Enrichment, Innovation and Operations, and Avery Hines, Director of Health Services

Presentations of the Public (not to begin before 7:00 pm)

“Regular Meetings of the School Committee include this ‘Presentations of the Public’ agenda item to give any resident the opportunity to place a presentation before the School Committee. A resident may only present once at any meeting.

These presentations are an opportunity for the public to make a presentation to the Committee but are not opportunities for dialog with the Committee. If one or more members of the Committee wishes to have a conversation about the topic presented, a member may request that the item be added to a subsequent Regular Meeting.

The details for submitting a presentation can be found within the policy BEDH, Public Comment and Presentations of the Public”

Pursuant to policy BEDH, Public Comment and Presentations of the Public - any resident in the audience may be given permission to speak once on any item on the agenda for up to three (3) minutes. The speaker is expected to keep their comments to the item on the agenda. The speaker must begin their comments by providing their full name and full Medford street address where they reside. A welcoming, inclusive community is both a value of the School Committee and an aspirational goal. We ask for your help in achieving this goal and value your perspective. Employees of the Medford Public Schools are exempt from the residency requirement of this policy. The voice of our employees is welcomed on all matters before this body. When a non-Medford-resident employee is participating in public comment or submitting a presentation of the public they will include their home address and identify themselves as an employee of the Medford Public Schools.

VII. Continued Business - None

VIII. New Business

2024 - 2 Offered by Member Graham, Member Ruseau, and Mayor Lungo-Koehn

Whereas, Medford High School has been accepted into the Eligibility Phase of the Massachusetts School Building Authority (MSBA) capital project pipeline, and whereas the Medford School Committee seeks to accelerate the time spent in the Eligibility Phase wherever possible, and whereas the Building Committee will require a substantial amount of information that only the Superintendent's team can provide once it is established;

Be it resolved that the School Committee requests the Superintendent to begin working to collect the data necessary to complete key deliverables in the MSBAs eligibility process, including Educational Profile Questionnaire, Chapter 74 Viability, and Maintenance and

Capital Planning Questionnaire. Be it further resolved that an initial draft of the information required to complete these documents is created no later than March 31, 2024.

Date Submitted: January 24, 2024

Date Requested to be on the Agenda: January 29, 2024

2024 - 3 Offered by Member McLaughlin

Motion for Annual School Committee Agenda

Whereas the Mass Association for School Committees recommends best practice for scheduling
and agenda setting for school committee efficacy,

Whereas communication, planning and transparency is in the best interest of the community,

Whereas Medford Public Schools has an identified strategic plan and clear goals,

Whereas there has historically been an identified pre-schedule to the meetings primarily only
known to the Chair and Superintendent,

Be it Resolved, the Medford School Committee, working together through the Chair and Superintendent, create an annual School Committee agenda annually in August with agenda items identified and correlated to relevant goals, to be published by September 5 of the same school year,

Be it Further Resolved ad hoc items to the School Committee agenda be added the Wednesday
prior to the upcoming School Committee meeting as required by public notice and emailed to
school committee members.

Date Submitted: January 24, 2024

Date Requested to be on the Agenda: January 29, 2024

IX. Reports Requested

Substitute Pay Offered by Member Graham and Member Ruseau

- i. Name of the report
 1. Substitute Teacher Supply and Demand Report
- ii. One or more questions the report is attempting to answer (required)

1. What is the annual need (using School Year 2022-2023 and September - December 2023) for substitutes by level for teachers and paraprofessionals (elementary, middle, high) and by school?
2. How many substitute slots are filled by level and school for the same time frames?
3. How does Medford's substitute pay for teachers and paraprofessionals compare to surrounding communities?
4. How is substitute demand vs availability tracked within central administration?

iii. Background

1. Substitute teachers play a critical role in maintaining educational continuity and quality when regular teachers are absent; meanwhile, Medford appears to struggle to obtain enough substitutes to cover the need.
2. Concerns have been raised for a long while regarding the adequacy of compensation for substitute teachers and the potential effect of compensation on the quality and availability of substitutes.
3. Understanding patterns and reasons for teacher absenteeism is crucial for addressing any underlying issues and ensuring the effective allocation of resources.

iv. Data elements you are expecting

1. Substitute Teacher Compensation:
 - a) Current compensation rates for substitute teachers across MPS, including any variations by level, education, etc.
 - b) Comparison of these rates with surrounding communities and averages
 - c) Recommendations for any adjustments or changes to the substitute teacher compensation structure
 - d) Identification of which communities used in the comparison have their substitute teachers within a Collective Bargaining Unit.
2. Substitute Need:
 - a) Data on the rates and patterns of substitute needs by level and school since September 2022
 - b) Identification of maximum and minimum substitute needs by date for each level and school (e.g., our lowest substitute need for the x school was # for the date mm/dd/yyyy and our highest for the same school was # for the date mm/dd/yyyy)
 - c) Analysis of the reasons for teacher absenteeism, including but not limited to personal illness, professional development, and other leaves
3. Substitute Availability:
 - a) Data on the rates and patterns of substitute availability by level and school since September 2022
 - b) Identification of maximum and minimum substitute availability by date for each level and school (e.g., our lowest substitute availability

for the X school was # for the date mm/dd/yyyy and our highest for the same school was # for the date mm/dd/yyyy)

- c) Number of substitutes registered as potential staff by school at the beginning, middle, and end of each school year (since September 2022, along with any other data about peak availability or minimum availability
- d) Daily unmet need for substitutes by level and school since September 2023
- 4. Survey Current and Past Substitutes as well as current teachers and paraprofessionals:
 - a) Collect information from current and past substitutes about why substitutes choose this work, the average number of days they work in a school year, whether they are available to take on more days, what limits they have (certain schools, etc), and any other input on the role that is relevant
 - b) Collect information from current teachers and paraprofessionals about substitute availability and the scope of what teachers expect from substitutes
- 5. Budget Impact:
 - a) Annual budget for substitute coverage for the last 3 fiscal years
 - b) Annual spending for the same three fiscal years per school
 - c) Number of coverage periods provided by teachers/paras during prep sessions since September 2022, along with coverage period rate and cost per school
- 6. Recommendations and next steps by the administration to address the report findings around substitute supply and demand
- v. Date that the report should be provided: **April 8, 2024**
- X. Condolences

The Members of the Medford School Committee express their sincerest condolences to the family of **James “Jack” McDevitt**, who taught business education, government and law over the course of his 37 years of teaching at Medford High School. In 1986, Mr. McDevitt was instrumental in working with the Medford Cooperative Bank to establish a branch of the bank at the high school.

The Members of the Medford School Committee express their sincerest condolences to the family of **Mariellen Parks**, sister of Larry Parks, custodian at Medford High School.

The Members of the Medford School Committee express their sincerest condolences to the family of **Yvon J. Richard**, father-in-law of Maureen Richard, Administrative Assistant at the McGlynn School and grandfather of Megan & David Richard, physical education teachers at the Medford Public Schools.

The Members of the Medford School Committee express their sincerest condolences to the family of **George Crook**, father of Chef Matthew Crook of the Bistro and loving husband of 54 years to Elaine (Therrien) Crook.

The Members of the Medford School Committee express their sincerest condolences to the family of **Elizabeth “Betsy” Schreuer**, a colleague and librarian with Medford Public Schools, wife of Gary Klein and mother of Rachel, Lydia and Josh Klein all Medford public school graduates or students.

XI. Next Meeting

February 5, 2024 - Alden Memorial Chambers, Medford City Hall in addition to zoom

XII. Adjournment